destruction in space, then there must be practical ways to prevent such possibilities.

Of course, I have in mind not general assurances but concrete verifiable means that both sides can rely on to avoid those contingencies. Neither of which is part of U.S. strategy or planning. I honestly believe that we can find a solution to this problem if we approach it in a practical fashion rather than debating generalities. I would like nothing more by our next meeting than to have found acceptable ways to solve the problem. But I believe it will require two things: accelerating negotiations to reach agreement on the way to reduce offensive weapons by fifty per cent and discussion of concrete ways to insure that any future development of defensive systems cannot be used as a cover for a first strike strategy or for basing weapons of mass destruction in space. Aside from these broader issues, I believe recent proposals bring settlement of intermediate range missiles closer and there are improved measures in several areas.

Regarding regional conflicts, I see that our respective analyses of the causes are incompatible. I see little point in continuing to debate the matter, on which we are bound to disagree. I suggest we simply look at the current situation in pragmatic terms. I think it would show two very important facts. The Soviet Union is engaged in a war in another country and the United States is not. And furthermore, this war is unlikely to bring any benefit to the Soviet Union, so why is it continued? Certainly not because of the United States. Even if we wished we do not have the power to induce thousands of people to take up arms against a well trained foreign army equipped with the most modern weapons. And neither we nor any other country other than the Soviet Union has the power to stop that war.